Weekly Update #2

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Project: PhishLens | Update Date: 9/30/26

1. Progress Since Last Meeting

- **Reviewed the proposal feedback (0.5 hr).** The proposal was approved. Two items were identified for revision: the Table of Contents page numbers and the extension-to-API authentication design.
- **Planned the authentication redesign (1 hr).** The single static extension API key will be replaced with per-install tokens that are treated as revocable identifiers rather than secrets.
- **Planned purchases and accounts (1 hr).** Checked costs and requirements for the domain name, VPS, and API access.
- **Re-sequenced the project schedule (0.5 hr)** so that Intermediate Milestone #1 remains on track.

2. Planned Progress This Week

Proposal revision (2 hrs)

- Regenerate the Table of Contents and verify every page number.
- Rewrite the "Client" and "Scoring Service and API" sections with the new authentication design:
  - On first run, the extension calls a `/register` endpoint and receives a per-install token.
  - The API treats that token as an identifier, not a secret.
  - Protection comes from per-token rate limits, payload size limits, token revocation, and a check that requests come from the extension's own origin.
  - No privileged data sits behind the API, and all real secrets (the Safe Browsing key and database credentials) stay server-side.

Purchases and accounts (1.5 hrs)

- Set up the accounts and purchases listed in the table below.

WBS 1.1 - Corpus work (8 hrs)

- Download the SpamAssassin and Nazario corpora.
- De-duplicate them and normalize both into one common record format.

WBS 1.2 - Development setup (4 hrs)

- Create the GitHub repository and configure `.gitignore` and environment-file handling so secrets are never committed.
- Set up the local Python environment and the Docker / Docker Compose scaffolding.

Total estimated time this week: about 15.5 hours

Purchase and Account Plan

Item	Purpose	Est. Cost	When
GitHub Student Developer Pack	Free repository tools, plus hosting credit and domain offers	Free	This week
Domain name	Required for Let's Encrypt TLS and a stable API address	~$10-15/yr (possibly free via Student Pack)	This week

Item	Purpose	Est. Cost	When
Google Cloud project + Safe Browsing API key	URL reputation lookups	Free (non-commercial)	This week
2 test Gmail accounts	Seeded end-to-end testing	Free	This week
Cloud VPS (Ubuntu LTS, 2 GB+ RAM)	Production host	~$6-12/mo (Student Pack credit may cover)	Choose now, provision at WU6

Expected project cost: roughly $25-50 for the semester (domain plus 2-3 months of VPS hosting), and potentially close to $0 with GitHub Student Pack credits. All other tools in the remaining updates (Python, ML libraries, PostgreSQL, Docker, Nginx, Let's Encrypt, Safe Browsing) are free. The Chrome Web Store fee is not needed because the extension is delivered unpacked.

3. Changes from the Project Proposal

- **Authentication design:** changed from one static extension API key to per-install revocable tokens, in response to proposal feedback. This adds a small `/register` endpoint to WBS 3.4, increasing its estimate from about 6 to 7 hours.
- **Schedule re-sequencing:** WBS 1.1 and 1.2 are completed this week. WBS 1.3-1.5 move to Weekly Update #3 (10/7). WBS 2.1 and IM1 preparation move into the open week before IM1 (week of 10/12). The IM1 date and demonstration content are unchanged.
- **Proposal document:** updated to correct the Table of Contents page numbers.

4. Team Evaluation

N/A - individual project.